

make the option of joining Maoists an unattractive proposition for the poor with good, just and unbiased governance, Maoist influence is bound to grow. Also, more COBRA operations in the long run will end up pushing more and more of the oppressed and poor into the Naxal folds.

VITULL K. GUPTA, *Bhatinda*

Common Tragedy

Your article on the upcoming Commonwealth Games was an eye-opener ("Commonwealth Shame", October 26). The Government should take full control of the organising committee and monitor the progress on infrastructure on a daily basis to avoid loss of face. With the security situation in the country far from satisfactory, we do not know how many countries will withdraw at the last minute. Moreover, it is no secret that games of such magnitude are not going to benefit either our sportspersons or our people. A huge amount of money is going to be wasted with no returns.

R. MURALIKUMAR, *Chennai*

Youth Connect

Rahul Gandhi has done well to connect to the young minds that are looking forward into the future ("A Big Hand", October 26). It clearly shows that his new Congress is quietly taking shape and has the potential to bring about a

rapid change. The country needs it and it is our responsibility to encourage the youth to participate in our nation's development. The time has now come when we would see our nation rising and leading the world not due to its leaders but on the shoulders of the common people, poor and youth.

VINOD C. DIXIT,
via www.indiatoday.in

There is no doubt that Rahul is rising fast not only on the political hori-



Kerala should take special interest in the International Container Transshipment Terminal to make it bloom and extract the greatest advantage for the state and country.

A.J. SAHAYAM, *Thiruvananthapuram*

zon but also in the esteem he commands from the people, particularly the weak and meek. If his way of functioning has attracted his partymen and adversaries alike, it is because rendering appreciation has become inevitable in his case.

THARCIUS S. FERNANDO,
Chennai

Match-struck

The makeover of the Indian male's mindset in choosing a wife shows that he has come to terms with the fact that women are equal to them in all spheres of life ("A Suitable Girl", October 12). The woman of today, however, has high expectations from a prospective husband and matching them is quite a task for many men.

K.C. KUMAR, *Bangalore*

Rebuilding Bengal

Being a student of econ-

omics, I've often wondered if the state of West Bengal can ever be uplifted ("Lord of the Ruins", October 12). The key is to introduce employment generation schemes for the rural sector and provide greater incentives to the corporates in the industrial sector.

ISHA GUPTA, *Delhi*

30
YEARS
AGO IN
INDIA
TODAY

JANUARY 1-15, 1980

Indira Heading for a Victory

As India's mammoth election machinery creaks into a high gear, and the country's self-serving politicians make their last desperate manoeuvres to shake a disgusted electorate of 362 million to vote, it is evident that it will be the hand symbol on the ballot paper that will be stamped more often than any other. And there is no mistaking as to whom the hand belongs. It is the hand of the woman who ruled India for 11 eventful years. If Mrs Gandhi does win the election, it will be a victory of stamina, shrewd manipulation, charisma and effective organisation over a flat-footed, effete, blundering opposition. It would not be a triumph of any ideology but rather a triumph of her ability to convince a weary electorate faced with only one other alternative that she is the only leader capable of solving India's problems. In this, she has been aided by her successors who, by their criminal ineptitude in government, have presented the country to her on a golden platter.

by *Asok Lahiri and Prannoy Roy*



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